

Switch Configuration — Guided Notes ANSWER KEY

Unit 2.1.3 | CompTIA Network+ N10-009 Obj. 2.1 | N10-008 2.1

For instructor use / distribute after students complete the notes.

Question 1

The first access method used on a new unconfigured switch is a _____ cable connected to the _____ port. Terminal settings are: _____ baud, _____ data bits, _____ parity, _____ stop bit.

Answer: Console (rollover); console port; 9600 baud; 8 data bits; no parity; 1 stop bit.

Question 2

You should always use _____ instead of _____ to protect the privileged EXEC password, because the latter stores it in _____. The command _____ applies weak encryption to all plaintext passwords in the config.

Answer: enable secret; enable password; plaintext; service password-encryption.

Question 3

To configure SSH, three prerequisites are required: (1) _____, (2) _____, and (3) _____. The VTY lines must be set to _____ to prevent Telnet access.

Answer: Hostname configured; IP domain name configured; RSA key pair generated (crypto key generate rsa); transport input ssh.

Question 4

Write the commands to create VLAN 10 named CLASSROOM and assign GigabitEthernet0/1 to it as an access port:

Answer: vlan 10 / name CLASSROOM / exit / interface GigabitEthernet0/1 / switchport mode access / switchport access vlan 10

Question 5

Write the commands to configure GigabitEthernet0/48 as a trunk carrying VLANs 10, 20, and 30 with native VLAN 99:

Answer: interface GigabitEthernet0/48 / switchport mode trunk / switchport trunk allowed vlan 10,20,30 / switchport trunk native vlan 99

Question 6

The running-config lives in _____ and is lost on reboot. The startup-config is loaded at boot. The command to save is _____. If you skip this step after making changes and the switch reboots, the result is _____.

Answer: RAM; copy running-config startup-config (or copy run start); all configuration changes are lost.

Question 7

Match each show command to what it verifies:

show vlan brief → _____

show interfaces trunk → _____

show mac address-table → _____

show interfaces Gi0/1 → _____

Answer: show vlan brief → VLAN assignments per port; show interfaces trunk → active trunks, allowed VLANs, native VLAN; show mac address-table → learned MAC addresses and which port each is on; show interfaces Gi0/1 → speed, duplex, error counters, status.

Question 8 — Real World Application

REAL WORLD: After configuring VLANs and trunks on two switches, devices on VLAN 20 can't communicate between switches but VLAN 10 works fine. What commands do you run and what are you looking for?

Answer: Run 'show interfaces trunk' on both switches. Check: (1) Is the trunk port in trunking mode on both sides? (2) Is VLAN 20 in the allowed VLAN list on both sides? (3) Does the native VLAN match? Run 'show vlan brief' to confirm VLAN 20 exists on both switches — a VLAN must be created locally on each switch to be active. The most likely cause is VLAN 20 not being in the allowed list on the trunk, or VLAN 20 not existing on one of the switches.